07-03 第2篇

# 阅读理解（议论文） Should Parents Pay Children for Doing Housework?

In many modern families, a popular question is discussed at the dinner table: *Should parents pay their children for doing housework?* Some parents give their child ten yuan for washing dishes, or twenty yuan for a full clean of the bathroom. Others feel strongly against this. In my view, **children should not be paid cash for daily housework that belongs to the whole family, although "special jobs" can be rewarded in other ways**.

My first reason is about the **nature of housework**. A family is not a company. When Mum cooks dinner, she is not paid by Dad; when Dad fixes the lamp, he is not paid by Mum. Housework is one of the ways family members show love and **responsibility** for one another. If children are paid for every little task, we slowly change the idea of home. Home becomes a small shop, and love becomes a kind of exchange. Before long, a child may even ask, "How much will you pay me today?" before saying "Good morning."

A second reason is about **motivation**. Psychologists have studied this problem for years. In one classic study, two groups of children were asked to tidy a messy room. One group was paid; the other was only thanked. After a week, the paid group stopped helping as soon as the money stopped, while the "thank-you group" kept helping. Why? Because when we do something only for money, the **inner motivation** fades away. The joy of "I can help my family" is quietly replaced by the dry question "How much?"

Of course, those who support payment also have a point. They say children must learn that money is earned by work, not given as a gift. I agree with this idea — but it should be taught in a smarter way. **Daily tasks should stay free**: making the bed, clearing the table, taking out rubbish. These are a child's **basic share** in the family. **Special tasks**, however, can be fair — for example, washing the car for two hours, painting the wooden fence, or caring for a neighbour's dog while they travel. These are beyond a normal child's share, so a small payment is reasonable. Through such tasks, a child does learn the value of work without losing the spirit of home.

Another reason to be careful is **relationships**. If my little brother and I are always paid, a silent competition starts: who cleans faster? who earns more this month? The warm feeling of helping each other can turn into arguing over who did which task. Worse still, a child may refuse to help a tired grandparent simply because "nobody pays me for that". Family love cannot survive many such small wounds.

To sum up, paying for daily housework may seem fair at first, but in the long run it can weaken what really matters. Let daily tasks be free, let special efforts be rewarded, and

let children learn what can never be printed on a paper bill: that helping the people we love is, in itself, a very good deal.

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**根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。**

**1. What is the writer's main opinion?**

A. Parents should pay children for every kind of housework.
B. Parents should never reward children for any task at all.
C. Children should not be paid for daily housework, but "special jobs" can be rewarded in other ways.
D. Children should not do any housework until they grow up.

**2. In the study about the messy room, which group kept helping after a week?**

A. The paid group.
B. The "thank-you" group.
C. Both groups equally.
D. Neither group.

**3. According to the writer, which of the following is a "daily task"?**

A. Washing the car for two hours.
B. Painting the wooden fence.
C. Caring for a neighbour's dog during their trip.
D. Clearing the dinner table.

**4. How can paying for daily housework hurt family relationships?**

A. Children may compare how much each earns and refuse to help unpaid people, such as grandparents.
B. Parents may spend all their money.
C. Children would stop going to school.
D. The house would become dirtier because nobody works.

**5. What does the writer mean by "a very good deal"?**

A. Paying less money for more housework.
B. Helping the people we love is worth more than money.
C. Finding a cheap shop near home.
D. Selling old toys to friends.

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# 答案与解析

**1.**
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】首段尾句
【解析】日常家务不应给钱，特殊任务可奖励。A/B/D 均偏离。故选 C。

**2.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"thank-you group kept helping"
【解析】只被道谢的那组继续帮忙。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

**3.**
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"basic share... Clearing the table"
【解析】清理餐桌属于日常。A/B/C 属于"特殊任务"。故选 D。

**4.**
【答案】A
【题型】因果推理题
【定位】"who cleans faster... refuse to help a tired grandparent"
【解析】攀比+拒帮无偿者。B/C/D 均错。故选 A。

**5.**
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】"helping the people we love is, in itself, a very good deal"
【解析】帮家人本身就是价值。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

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**词汇注释（超纲词）**

- **responsibility** [n.] 责任
- **motivation** [n.] 动力
- **psychologist** [n.] 心理学家
- **inner** [adj.] 内在的
- **reward** [v.] 奖励